

Deer velvet in S. Korea (2nd quarter of 2026)

Reported on 13th of July 2026

1 Quarantine statistics of deer velvet from major export countries⁹

1.1 Dried velvet

Dried velvet (kg)								
Country	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026 (~June)
New Zealand	44,535	37,811	24,369	39,655	47,958	16,884	8,891	3,673.9
China	69,716	77,990	72,634	89,569	74,318	89,458	90,488	36,527.4
Russia	46,450	54,042	55,986	43,896	29,109	39,861	36,441	21,258.7
Hong Kong	17,828	13,701	22,372	23,835	12,597	4,347	3,699	1,800
Kazakhstan	701	2,354	1,428	2,097	1,095	413	1,058	
Total	179,782	185,931	176,842	199,086	165,095	150,974	140,588	63,264

1.2 Frozen velvet

Frozen velvet (kg)								
Country	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026 (~June)
New Zealand	99,113	77,477	91,874	116,584	116,292	76,939	94,225	48,629
China	10		2		2.6	443.8	1,356.5	
Russia								
Total	99,124	77,477	91,877	116,591	116,295	77,382	95,582	48,629

1.3 Rolling year

Dried velvet (kg)			Frozen velvet (kg)		
Country	Jul 2024 - Jun 2025	Jul 2025 - Jun 2026	Country	Jul 2024 - Jun 2025	Jul 2025 - Jun 2026
New Zealand	8,828	9,725	New Zealand	98,552.9	65,899.6

China	71,287	96,050	China	31.8	1,350.0
Russia	41,147	32,481	Russia		
Hong Kong	6,659	3,100	Hong Kong		0.1
Kazakhstan	413	1,058	Kazakhstan		
Australia	8	8.5	Australia		
USA	0.5	2.4	USA		
Others	1.7	0.4	Others		
Total	128,344	142,425	Total	98,585	67,250

2 Korean news

2.1 Haman county faces dilemma after culling sika deer following mascot launch

According to a report by Haman County in Gyeongsangnam-do is facing a difficult situation just one month after introducing its new deer-inspired mascot, Hamtori. On 16 March, local authorities shot and buried two abandoned Sika deer found near a mountain trail in Chilwon-eup. This decision followed a Ministry of Environment amendment that classified **abandoned Sika deer as harmful wildlife** due to community complaints and agricultural damage. Ironically, the **new mascot Hamtori was modeled after a deer-shaped pottery piece excavated** from Tomb No. 45 of the Marisan Tumuli, a registered **World Heritage site located in the county**. Shin Ju-un, an activist from the animal rights group KARA, argued that blanket culling is not a sustainable solution. She suggested that because Haman County uses a deer as its official symbol, local authorities should investigate non-lethal management options, such as immunocontraception or electric fencing, to organise a successful coexistence plan.



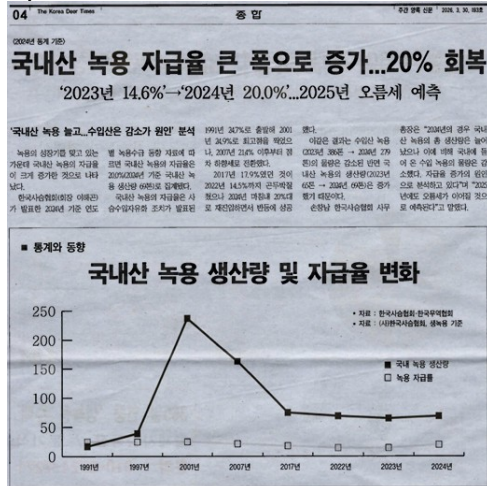
Yonhap News, 2026-03-28¹

2.2 Call for urgent research into PLS for Korean deer velvet farm sector

Korea Deer Breeders Association (Chairman Lee Hae-gon) met with the Animal Genetic Resources Center of the National Institute of Animal Science (Director Han Man-hee) on 25 March. During the meeting, Chairman Lee requested urgent research into the **Positive List System (PLS)** for the deer industry, noting a critical lack of **residue data and management standards for medications used during velvet antler harvesting**. Currently, farmers use various drugs for anesthesia, cutting, and treatment—specifically anesthetics, sedatives, hemostatics, disinfectants, antibiotics, and anti-inflammatories—but have no formal safety manuals. Director Han Man-hee agreed that policy support should expand from major livestock to special livestock sectors to ensure food safety and pledged to submit a formal recommendation to the Ministry of Agriculture, Food and Rural Affairs (MAFRA) after a multi-faceted review of the farmers' concerns.

¹ <https://www.yna.co.kr/view/AKR20260327082100052>

imported velvet antler, which fell from **386 tonnes in 2023 to 279 tonnes in 2024**. Simultaneously, domestic velvet antler production experienced a slight increase from 65 tonnes to 69 tonnes. Historically, the domestic self-sufficiency rate peaked **at 24.9% in 2001** before entering a long decline, dropping to a low of 14.5% in 2022. Secretary-General of KDBA Son Chang-nam predicts this upward trend will continue into 2025.



The Korea Deer Times, 2026-03-30

2.5 JungKwanJang launches children's nutrition campaign for Cheonnok Growing Kids

Advertorial: JungKwanJang has launched the Wonbamsong(I've finished my dish!) Challenge to promote positive mealtime habits among children as part of its Cheonnok Growing Kids brand campaign. The challenge encourages parents and children to sing and dance together, then upload a video to Instagram by April 30. The campaign runs until May 16.

The Cheonnok Growing Kids products contain New Zealand SAT-grade deer velvet antler, red ginseng, and herbal extracts, with intake safety verified through human testing. Participants can win a one-year product subscription, while all entrants receive 5,000 won (≈ USD 3.70) in Naver Pay points.



Open News, 2026-04-07²

² <https://www.ownews.tv/news/articleView.html?idxno=278045>

2.6 Rory McIlroy hosts most expensive Champions Dinner in masters history

The 2025 Masters champion, Rory McIlroy (from Northern Ireland), hosted the most expensive Champions Dinner in the history of the tournament. The exclusive traditional dinner, which was served on 7 April (local time) ahead of the tournament, was priced at an unprecedented \$318 USD per person including the Grilled **Elk Sliders** (*Translated in Korean as the venison burger).



Asia Business Daily, 2026-04-08³

2.7 Highest yield at herd size of 30 stags or fewer, averaging 12.3kg per animal

The Animal Genetic Resources Centre released the 'Survey and Analysis Report on the Business Status of Domestic Deer Farms'. The report shows that deer farms with a herd size of 30 head or fewer achieve the highest average velvet antler production per stag. Conversely, feed costs per head decrease as the herd size grows larger.

Classification	30 Head or Fewer	31-60 Head	Over 60 Head	Average
Production per Head (<i>Nyang</i>)	327.2	322.7	279.0	296.5
Production per Head (kg)	12.3	12.1	10.5	11.1
Feed Cost per Head (KRW)	962,922	1,057,932	688,951	818,221

Financial and operational highlights of Korean deer farm

- **Income:** The average annual income per deer is **1,502,671 KRW**, with an income rate of **41.8%**.
- **Cost structure:** Feed costs account for **22.4%** of total farming operating expenses. This includes concentrated feed (12.2%), roughage (5.9%), and Total Mixed Ration (TMR) feed (4.3%). Livestock purchasing costs make up **3.9%** of the expenses.
- **Breeding trends:** Small paddocks with 30 head or fewer focus on intensive breeding of high-quality stags to maximise velvet antler weight. Meanwhile, large paddocks reduce costs through automated feeding systems.

³ <https://www.asiae.co.kr/article/2026040821482236121>

The Korea Deer Times

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(마리당)

30두 사육시 녹용생산량 가장 높아...평균 12.3kg

가축유전자원센터 '국내 사슴농가 경영실태 조사분석 보고' 밝혀

사슴 마리당 연 소득액 150만원...소득률 41.8%

(표) 사슴 사육 규모별 두당 녹용생산량 및 사료비

구분	30두 이하	31-50두	50두 초과	평균
두당 녹용생산량(kg)	327.2	322.7	279.0	296.5
두당 녹용생산량(kg)	12.3	12.1	10.5	11.1
두당 사료비(원)	962,922	1,057,932	688,951	878,221

· 자료 : 국내 사슴농가 경영실태 조사분석 결과보고서
국립축산과학원 가축유전자원센터

사슴의 마리당 평균 녹용 생산량은 사육규모 30두 이하일 때 가장 높고, 사육규모는 40두를 초과하는 대형농장 일수록 비용 지출이 낮은 것으로 나타났다.

국립축산과학원 가축유전자원센터(원장 박민준)는 지난 2025년 8월부터 11월까지 4개월간 전국 양육인 40개소를 대상으로 실시한 '국내 사슴농가 경영실태 조사분석 결과보고서'를 발표했다.

(표 참조) 사슴사육 규모별 30두 기준 1개의 그룹으로 나눠 실시한 조사 보고서에 따르면 사슴 마리당 녹용 생산량은 사육규모 30두 이하의 소규모 일수록 높았다. 마리당 평균 녹용 생산량은 30두 이하

일 때 327.2kg(12.3kg)으로 가장 많았고, 31-40두 사육일 때 322.7kg(12.1kg), 40두 초과 사육에서는 279.0kg으로 집계됐다. 전체 평균 녹용생산량은 마리당 296.5kg(11.1kg)이다.

마리당 사료비 지출액은 사육두수가 대규모일수록 낮았다. 사육규모 40두를 초과할 때의 마리당 사료비 지출은 688,951원이었으며, 30두 이하 962,922원, 31-40두 일 때 1,057,932원으로 비용 지출이 오히려 높았다.

사슴 30두 이하의 소규모 농장에서 마리당 녹용생산량이 가장 높게 나타났다 것은 녹용 생산 위주의 수확을 사육규모 확대와 우수사슴 종양의 경영에 사육이 보류 여부에 따라 비용 편차

가 크다고 보고자는 밝혔다. 큰 수입액은 3,903,409원, 비 사육규모 등에 소요되는 가축 용 209만2,328원으로 마리당 소득액은 150만2,071원, 소득률 사슴농가 소득 분석에서 평균 41.8%라고 덧붙였다.

■ 바로 잡습니다

본지 193호 9면 (행방-가업) 있는 우리사슴목장) 재하의 본문 내용중 '김순중 대표의 사슴사육 강박을 40년에서 1995년 양목업을 시작하여 올해로 32년째 접어든다'로 바로 잡습니다.



- The photo section highlights excellent genetic selection in **Elk** (*Cervus canadensis*) stags, showcasing thick brow tines and prominent *boon-gol* (top tip) structures.
- The Korea Deer Times, 2026-04-15

2.8 Velvet antler: the synonym for premium tonics... Why is local Korean better?

To scientifically verify the differences, the Korea Deer Association commissioned a comparative analysis by a research team led by Professor **Ha Heon-yong** from the **Department of Pharmaceutical Engineering at Seowon University**. In March, the team published a report titled '**Research Project Report on the Efficacy and Functions of Domestic Elk Velvet Antler**'.

- Higher Yield: Local Elk (*Cervus canadensis*) velvet antler demonstrates an active ingredient extraction yield 2.5 times higher than imported alternatives.
- Skin hydration: The active compounds significantly stimulate the production of hyaluronic acid, which retains essential moisture in human skin cells and bodily tissues.
- Immune & joint support: Lab tests confirm robust antioxidant, anti-inflammatory, nitric oxide scavenging, and antiviral cytokine-regulating functions.
- Traditional benefits: Proven to boost stamina, accelerate childhood growth, enhance memory, and aid postpartum recovery.
- Diverse diet: Local deer range freely across a distinct four-season environment, grazing on dozens of natural wild herbs, medicinal plants, and shrubs.
- Import contrast: Most imported products **originate from single-type grass pastures, limiting the animals' nutrient intake.**

보약의 대명사 녹용...왜 국내산이 더 좋을까?

면역력 증진·항산화 기능·관절 건강·피부건조 완화 입증

**‘뚜렷한 사계절 등 환경에서 자라 품질 우수’
유효한 성분 추출률...수입 비배 2.5배!**

한의학에서 으뜸으로 꼽히는 귀한 약재인 녹용은 예로부터 보정강장약으로 쓰였다. 신체 정력 회복을 돕고 신진대사를 강화하는 약재라는 뜻이다. 일반적으로 남성에게 좋은 것으로 알려져 있지만 기력이 쇠한 여성과 어린이들에게도 원기를 회복하는 데 도움을 준다.

녹용은 부드럽고 얇은 털로 덮여 있어 항상 따뜻함을 유지한다. 땀 양적으로 많은 혈관이 지나 갈수록 풍부하다. 늦은 봄에 자랄로 떨어지는 데 그 자리에 봄철 새싹이 돋아나고 여러 가지가 돋아난다. 가을이 되면 봄 때와 같은 양이 단단하게 굳어 각질화되는 데 이런 짧은 녹용보다 효능이 떨어지거나 녹이라고 한다. 시중에 약재로 유통되는 것들은 5~7월 잘라낸 신선한 재료로 생녹용이라 부른다. 생녹용을 건조 처리한 것을 건녹용이라고 한다.

녹용은 건강식품으로 널리 애용되고 있다. 지금까지 알려진 성분들을 살펴보면 단백질, 칼슘, 칼리코사이드, 글리코겐 등이다. 이러한 성분들은 뼈와 연골 등 연결조직을 강화하고, 관절의 노화 방지를 도우며, 기억력 및 학습력을 증진시키고 피부질환 완화 등에 기능하는 것으로 알려져 있다. 또 어린이 성장발육을 돕고, 분만시 자궁 리완근의 수축을 촉진해 산후 몸조리에도 기능한다.

시중에 유통되는 녹용은 수입산이 많다. 수입 녹용은 낮은 효자에서 병해 사용 한 사슴에게서 취한다. 그러나 병해 사용 한 사슴이 섭취한 목초의 종류가 한두 가지로 제한되어 어류용이 낡는다. 이에 비해 국내산 녹용은 수심이 가파른 자연환경에서 자라기 때문에 품질이 우수하다.

한국사슴협회에서는 수입산과 국내산의 차이와 녹용의 효능을 보다 정확하게 알기 위해 서원

대학교 연구팀에 비교 분석을 의뢰했다. 연구를 진행한 제약공학과 하연우 교수는 지난 3월 ‘국내산 엘크사슴의 녹용 효능 연구’를 결과 보고서로 발표했다. 연구에 따르면 국내산 녹용은 성분 추출률 연구에 활용될 수 있는 유용한 성분 추출 수득률이 수입산에 비해 2.5배가량 높은 것으로 나타났다. 인체 각 조직 및 각질세포에서 수분 함량을 유지하는 데 중요한 역할을 하는 히알루론산의 생성과 유지에 국내산 녹용 성분이 탁월하게 기여하는 것도 밝혔다. 또 항산화 및 항염 활성 기능 실험에 있어서도 기존 천연소재와 유사한 수준의 기능을 하는 것으로 드러났으며, 산화질소, 소변 농도, 사마토카인(염반응물질) 생성 조절 효과도 국내산 녹용이 더 높은 것으로 나타났다.

■ 알면 힘이 되는 녹용 상식

녹용의 효능

어린이에게 유익한 ‘녹용’
기아력 및 두뇌 발달, 학습력 증진
성장발육 증진에 도움을 줍니다

예로부터 보약의 대명사로 전해져 내려오고 있는 ‘삼비’의 명약 - 녹용. 녹용의 효능, 효과에 대해서는 옛 의학 고서와 문헌에서 서술하고 있으며, 특히 최근에는 현대 의학적 접근 방식으로 다양한 연구가 진행 중이다. 본고는 고서와 문헌, 현대 의학의 효능·효과 등을 토대로 소비자들이 보다 알리 쉽게 정리한 것이다. 국내 양복인들에게 유익한 자료로 활용될 수 있을 것으로 판단해 게재한다. 다만 본고의 원고물 제외된 그림과 디자인의 저작권은 (양복신문)이 소유하고 있어 무단 사용을 금한다.

The Korea Deer Times, 2026-04-15

2.9 History, why Korean domestic velvet can't supply for traditional Korean medicine

Korean velvet antler can technically be supplied to traditional medical institutions if it is standardised by a licensed pharmaceutical manufacturer, it cannot realistically compete on price with imported velvet antler.

Timeline of the 'Herbal Medicine Standardisation' Policy

- **April 1996:** The Ministry of Health and Social Affairs—now the **Ministry of Food and Drug Safety (MFDS)**—introduces the 'Standardisation of Herbal Medicines' policy to improve product quality and restructure distribution.
- **Mandatory designation:** Velvet antler, licorice, and arrowroot are included in the initial group of 37 highly consumed medicinal herbs selected for mandatory standardisation.
- **Channel block:** The Pharmaceutical Affairs Act mandates that these 37 items can only be supplied to traditional Korean medicine clinics, hospitals, and pharmacies if processed **by a licensed pharmaceutical manufacturer, effectively blocking direct sales from domestic deer farms.**
- **Price Disadvantage:** Although domestic deer farmers can technically use licensed manufacturers to standardise their products, they cannot realistically compete on price with imported velvet antler in these medical channels.
- **Industry protest:** The domestic deer farming industry establishes an emergency committee and holds rallies to demand that velvet antler be allowed to circulate freely as a livestock product, but government authorities reject the proposal.
- **Regulatory amendments:** Later legal revisions permit highly restricted use of raw fresh velvet antler in specific decoctions but cap its inclusion at a maximum of **49%** of the total raw material composition when used as an ingredient in general food products.



The Korea Deer Times, 2026-04-15

2.10 Korean deer farmers are learning from the world deer biology congress remotely

According to the latest edition of Deer Industry News, scientist Dr David Stevens introduced methods to maximise antler productivity through a field case-study presentation. **Deer Industry News reported that the protein content fed to male stags during their first antler growth period at two years of age dictates future velvet antler productivity.**

To maximise productivity, Dr David Stevens urged the utilisation of clinical research. He explained, "Over the past 40 years, we observed graph data showing that the average velvet antler production per head for Red deer increased from 3.5kg to 10kg, and for Elk / Wapiti from 5kg to approximately 20kg. Adequate protein supply tailored to age and timing was vital to this background."

He added, "Protein is a highly critical factor in velvet antler production. The amount of protein supplied from the end of a fawn's first winter—when the first antlers begin growing—until harvesting that same year has the greatest impact on future velvet antler productivity."

Furthermore, the report noted that "A 24.5% protein intake is required during the period when the first antlers grow on a two-year-old stag. After that stage, the protein requirement gradually decreases and maintaining it between 10% and 20% causes no issues."

Age	Period	Crude Protein Content(%): Model 1	Crude Protein Content(%): Model 2
Fawn under 1 year old	Post-Weaning	28.0%	16.5%
2-year-old (First Antler) Stag	Winter	18.0%	11.5%
	Velvet Antler Growth Period	22.4%	24.5%
3 to under 4 years old	Winter	—	9.0%
	Velvet Antler Growth Period	19.0%	19.0%
Adult Stag over 4 years old	Winter	—	10.5%
	Velvet Antler Growth Period	17.0%	15.5%



The Korea Deer Times, 2026-04-15

2.11 Red Ginseng research presented on global academic stage

New research by KGC was presented at an international academic conference, raising expectations for global market expansion. **KGC CheongKwanJang brand, hosted** a seminar at the International Conference on the Science of Botanicals (ICSB) in Mississippi, United States, attended by about **400 participants including experts from the FDA and NIH.**

The studies reported potential benefits in neuroprotection, blood glucose control, anti-ageing, sleep quality, and overall quality of life. Researchers highlighted ginsenosides as a key compound, suggesting they may cross the blood-brain barrier and support neural protection. KGC said the growing body of scientific evidence will help build global consumer trust and expand overseas sales.



The Bloter, 2026-04-28⁴

2.12 Biodot develops deer velvet-based natural ingredient platform

2.1.2 Biodot develops deer velvet-based natural ingredient platform
(Advertorial) Biodot is a natural ingredient company focused on deer velvet (nokyeong) and antler-based materials, combining R&D, sourcing, and manufacturing in one system. It imports raw velvet from New Zealand and Russia and applies a proprietary cold-drying process, while developing a range of functional products such as extracts, powders, and fermented materials. The company is expanding beyond raw materials into a full OEM/ODM and customised R&D platform, supporting branding and product development. It is also growing its own finished products.



⁴ <https://www.bloter.net/news/articleView.html?idxno=660775>

Korea Urban Environment Herald, 2026-05-09⁵

2.13 Hy researcher wins science ministry award for muscle health ingredient

Hong Dong-gi, a senior researcher at hy, received the Minister's Award from the Ministry of Science and ICT at the 2026 science and technology promotion awards ceremony for developing **fermented deer velvet antler probiotic powder**, an ingredient shown to help maintain **muscle strength**.

The ingredient is a health functional food material individually approved for muscle maintenance. It is produced by fermenting deer velvet with hy's proprietary probiotic strain (*L. curvatus* HY7602) and is currently the only approved deer antler-based ingredient for muscle strength maintenance in Korea.

Its functionality and safety were confirmed through a 12-week human trial involving 100 adults with declining muscle strength. Participants who consumed 580 mg per day showed a 20.4% increase in grip strength, a 5.9% improvement in thigh muscle strength, and a 12.5% improvement in physical performance test results.



Food and Beverage News, 2026-05-12⁶

2.14 HENKIV study on NK cell activation published in international journal

Yuhan Care reported that its deer antler extract YC-1101 (HENKIV) was published in the Journal of Medicinal Food following joint research with Immunis-bio and Bundang Cha Hospital. The study examined its impact on NK cells, key immune cells.

Results showed increased NK cell activation and proliferation, including higher expression of receptors (NKG2D, NKp44) and cytokines (IFN- γ , TNF- α), along with improved mitochondrial function. In a mouse cancer model, combining YC-1101 with immune checkpoint inhibitors enhanced tumour suppression, with some complete responses observed.



⁵ <https://www.kueherald.co.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=58202>

⁶ <https://www.thinkfood.co.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=200261>

Chosun Biz, 2026-05-18⁷

2.15 Individually approved HFF sales fall to five-year low amid three years of decline

Sales of individually approved health functional foods in South Korea fell to KRW 666.2 billion (≈ USD 480 million) in 2025, returning to a level similar to 2020, according to data from the Korea Food Safety Information Service. This marks a continued contraction after the market peaked at KRW 851.1 billion in 2022. The sector has now recorded three consecutive years of negative growth, with demand weakening steadily since 2023. The decline was sharp at first but has become less severe over time. Sales dropped by 12.9% in 2023, followed by 6.8% in 2024, and 3.5% in 2025, indicating that while the market is still shrinking, the pace of decline is slowing.

By product category, lutein and zeaxanthin complex extracts remained the top-selling item for the second consecutive year in 2025. Despite overall market weakness, certain functional ingredients continue to sustain consumer demand. Industry observers see the moderating decline as a potential early signal of stabilisation, although the total market size remains significantly below its recent peak.



Yakup.com, 2026-06-16⁸

Appendix I. Spreadsheets are supplied separately

Import statistics. Korean import statistics for deer velvet.xlsx	Biosecurity pass recording not HS Code based trade records by export country . Source is Animal and Plant Quarantine Agency (농림축산검역본부 ⁹)
Food imports list.	Number of trade recording by food importers and products

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https://biz.chosun.com/industry/business_info/2026/05/18/YMFWLS4WNVHGZN4RXHUIVBZWMA/

⁸ <http://m.yakup.com/news/index.html?mode=view&cat=12&nid=328591>

⁹ <http://eminwon.qia.go.kr/statistics/> (품목-국가별 수출입현황)

Korean food imports list for deer velvet.xlsx	they imported. No volume or price of each trade but counting trade events. No data for imports for pharmaceutical purpose. Source is Imported Food Information Maru website (수입식품정보마루¹⁰)
Food products. Deer velvet food products in Korea.xlsx	Accumulated food product list over recent years. Based on various news article about product launching mostly supplied originally by the brand owner as a press release activity.

¹⁰ <https://impfood.mfds.go.kr/CECCC01F01>